

The Morning Newspaper

THURSDAY, OCTOBER 8, 2026 · AUSTIN EDITION

90° / 63°

Overcast, 0% rain, wind 7 mph

Tomorrow: 90° / 68°, clear

Sunrise 7:28 · Sunset 19:07

Waning crescent

Russian Strike on Commuter Bus Kills at Least 30 in Kramatorsk

Ukraine says Moscow is targeting crowded civilian vehicles as attacks on its cities surge to some of the deadliest of the war.

WORLD

Middle East Violence Deepens as Houthis Hit Riyadh, Tanker Struck Off Qatar

THE NEW YORK TIMES · BBC NEWS

Saudi-led forces said they intercepted two missiles aimed at Riyadh in the deadliest Houthi attack on the kingdom so far, a day after strikes elsewhere in Saudi Arabia killed three people. Separately, a maritime agency reported a tanker was hit by multiple projectiles in the Gulf off Qatar, with casualties reported aboard. Oil prices jumped as attacks on shipping near the Strait of Hormuz continued alongside the widening Saudi-Houthi war. The escalation comes as Riyadh has stepped up its own strikes on Houthi positions in Yemen, raising fears the conflict could draw in other Gulf states.

MARKETS

INDEX	LAST	CHG
S&P 500	7,778.11	-0.30%
Dow Jones	51,109.86	-0.14%
Nasdaq	27,394.52	-0.52%
Russell 2000	2,779.43	-0.49%
VIX	15.40	+2.12%
10-yr yield	5.29	+0.21%

CRYPTO

Bitcoin	\$81,792	-1.42%
Ethereum	\$2,505.93	-1.96%

STOCKS

NVDA	\$234.18	-1.39%
AAPL	\$337.01	+0.10%
MSFT	\$530.76	+0.19%
GOOGL	\$353.42	+0.83%
AMZN	\$258.28	-0.63%
META	\$720.04	-0.18%
AVGO	\$368.14	-2.22%
TSLA	\$373.54	-1.13%
SPCX	\$165.93	-1.00%
BRK-B	\$507.68	+0.28%
TSM	\$469.12	-0.65%

Stocks drifted lower as the Middle East violence pushed oil higher and rattled bond markets already on edge over France's debt troubles and UK borrowing costs, which hit a 19-year high; the 10-year Treasury yield climbed to 5.29%. Chipmakers led the selling, with Broadcom off 2.22% and Nvidia down 1.39% despite its push into robotics. Bitcoin and Ethereum fell in sympathy with the risk-off mood, though the VIX rose only modestly to 15.40, suggesting traders see the moves as a bond-and-oil story rather than a panic.

TECH

Microsoft and Google Push Deeper Into AI Hardware and Agents

ARS TECHNICA · TECHMEME

Microsoft used an event to debut new AI-friendly hardware and Windows changes aimed at putting more AI on the desktop, while Nvidia detailed a "physical AI" safety push for robotaxis and humanoid robots already being adopted by robotics firms. Google, meanwhile, unveiled a universal Gemini agent for multi-day enterprise workflows and a local macOS note-taking app built on a new small model, underscoring how fast the major platforms are racing to embed agents everywhere. Separately, OpenAI said it had disrupted a Russian influence campaign that used its models to target schools, media outlets and foreign officials.

CULTURE

Anne Carson Wins Nobel Prize in Literature

THE NEW YORK TIMES

The Toronto-born poet, essayist, translator and classics scholar, 76, was named this year's Nobel laureate in literature, joining a list of past winners that includes Toni Morrison, Samuel Beckett and Bob Dylan. Carson had long been considered a perennial contender for the prize alongside writers like Margaret Atwood.

BACK PAGE

Oil jumped as the Gulf grew tense, Nvidia bet big on self-driving sense, Wall Street dipped on bond-market fright — Anne Carson, at least, slept well tonight.

FROM THE FEEDS · FULL TEXT IN SECTION B

AEON

The ghetto on the lagoon — how 16th-century Venice, unable to expel its Jews, invented the world's first ghetto instead.

LONGREADS

The People of Utah vs. Kevin O'Leary — neighbors fight "Mr. Wonderful's" plan to build the world's largest data center.

LONGREADS

How AI Replaced Me — an edtech worker's account of what got left behind after an AI layoff.

NAUTILUS

How to Live to Be 194 Years Old — a tortoise's genetic hacks for longevity, and what they might teach us.

NAUTILUS

Neanderthals Were Adept Woodworkers Too — new research recovers a craft that rarely survives in the fossil record.

QUANTA MAGAZINE

As AI closed in on a famous proof, three computer scientists raced to publish before a machine beat them to it.

PSYCHE

Tuesdays with the Guys — a writer rethinks his male friendships after an unexpected tragedy.

TRICYCLE

Intent — on the quiet virtue of being honest with yourself in Buddhist practice.

LONGREADS

The People of Utah vs. Kevin O'Leary

SEYWARD DARBY · LONGREADS.COM · OCT 8, 2026

Mr. Wonderful wanted to build the world's largest data center, and the neighbors had other ideas.

In a remote part of Utah, the world's largest data center project—allegedly—is being fast-tracked in secret. Kevin O'Leary of Shark Tank fame was brought in to hype the 40,000-acre complex. But the backlash among Utahns has been strong. Josh Dzieza reports from the front lines of the popular resistance to data centers:

[Brenna] Williams, a former government econometrician and college instructor, speaks methodically in a calm monotone as she enumerates the many reasons why the data center “doesn’t make sense”—a refrain. First among them is the water, an acutely sensitive issue in Utah in part thanks to Gov. Cox himself, who has declared

repeated drought emergencies and urged residents to take shorter showers and cut back on watering their lawns. There is no more potent symbol of the state's water crisis than the Great Salt Lake, which has been shrinking for years, exposing heavy metals on its lakebed that become airborne dust. Now here came a data center on its northern shore, or where its northern shore would have been if it hadn't receded several miles.

“We have to report on our neighbors if they're watering at the wrong times or on the wrong days,” Williams says. (There's a hotline.) “But we have water to cool a power plant and cool the data center? It doesn't make sense.”

LONGREADS

The True Cost of Rape in America

SEYWARD DARBY · LONGREADS.COM · OCT 8, 2026

A deep look at who actually pays, financially and otherwise, after a sexual assault.

The horrific story of Jane Doe and the Cornell Seven has spurred nationwide outrage and revived contentious debates around prevention and education. But one question is going unasked: Who really pays after a sexual assault? In terms of actual dollars and cents? The answer, Cosmopolitan finds, isn't good:

Leah received an email from the first hospital. It was a bill for \$3,338, including \$663 for lab work and a pregnancy test she hadn't asked for. She hadn't been charged for the rape kit, but the price of just checking into the ER was \$2,241. After her parents' insurance was applied, she owed \$451.06.

“I was so unbelievably angry,” she says. “I lost it. I was like, ‘You mean it cost me \$450 to get raped?!’”

Most people don't realize this care might not be covered, says Vega, who has worked as an emergency room nurse, emergency room director, and a SANE. But that's actually common: KFF analyzed a sample of insurance claim data from 2016 to 2018 (the most up-to-date data KFF has) and found that 83 percent of women who received a sexual violence diagnosis were billed for treatment. Another analysis of emergency room department data from 2019 found that the average bill for sexual assault survivors was \$3,551, according to the New England Journal of Medicine.

LONGREADS

She Died at the San Diego Border. A Surveillance Camera Was in Plain Sight.

BRENDAN FITZGERALD · LONGREADS.COM · OCT 7, 2026

An investigation into why federal border surveillance hasn't stopped migrant deaths in the Otay Mountains.

There are more than 800 surveillance towers located along U.S. borders, a number that is expected to triple in the next decade. These towers, according to a government accountability report, “detect items of interest, such as people.” But interest can be fickle. As part of “Dying on Camera,” a sprawling package of features co-published by the MIT Technology Review and Times of San Diego, Lillian Perlmutter reports on the death of Graciela Gómez Hernández, one among hundreds of migrants whose final moments seem as though they should have been witnessed. “The proximity of so many deaths to high-resolution cameras leaves two distinct

possibilities,” Perlmutter writes. “Either the system didn't detect these people in distress, or it did detect them—and officials offered no response.”

Surveillance towers have proliferated in recent years, as contractors added newer camera systems that use artificial intelligence to distinguish border-crossers from other people and animals, and track their movements, at an overall cost of more than a billion dollars. Yet as the cameras scan the terrain, migrants continue to die in plain sight.

More features on surveillance technology

“Flock’s array of license-plate cameras was built to fight crime. But at least 50 law enforcement officers were charged with or accused of misusing it and other systems.”

“In the war on ‘shrink,’ big retailers are turning to one Florida outfit to study shoppers and prevent them from stealing. I went there—and saw far too much.”

“Tech titans claim the genre inspired them. But all they’ve done is graft their politics onto stories of a better future.”

AEON

The ghetto on the lagoon

ALEXANDER LEE · AEON.CO · OCT 8, 2026

The strange 1516 compromise that gave the world its first ghetto, in a Venice that needed its Jews but wanted them gone.

On 29 March 1516, the Venetian Senate voted to create the world’s first ‘ghetto’. All Jews then living in the city – as well as any others who might come later – were ordered to move immediately to a small island in the northeastern sestiere of Cannaregio, a neighbourhood known as the geto novo. It was anything but appealing. Previously used as a dumping ground for the communal copper foundry, it had been converted into a residential quarter for local workers. From the outside, it already looked ‘like a castle’ – ringed by canals and bounded by perilously tall tenements. But by the time Venice’s Jews were herded in, it seemed more like a prison. All outward-facing doors and windows were blocked up; extra walls were built to close off access to the water; and a pair of sturdy iron gates were placed at either end of the bridge leading to

Cannaregio. These were closed at sunset and opened in the morning at the ringing of the marangona bell. And just to be sure that no one could sneak out when they weren’t supposed to, four guards – paid for by the Jews themselves – patrolled the canals around the Ghetto ‘day and night’.

It was not the first time that Jews had ever been confined to a separate quarter, of course. By the early 16th century, Jews in France and in German lands had already been living in designated neighbourhoods, physically distinct from the surrounding areas, for close on 300 years. Nor was it even the first time Venice itself had toyed with the idea of Jewish confinement. Back in the 13th century, it had already obliged Jews in its Cretan colony’s capital Candia (now Heraklion) to live in a separate area.



Continued online (full article about 4124 words). Scan, or visit <https://aeon.co/essays/the-making-of-the-ghetto-on-a-venetian-island-in-1516>